

THE COMMAND APP · NATIVE IPHONE · 2 SEPTEMBER 2026 · SUPERSEDES V1.0

One app to rule them all. Rook is the board in a pocket — categorised queues cleared with checkboxes, context on tap, dispatches released with a thumb, a voice you can talk to on the motorway, and notifications that find you before deadlines do. Native on the phone, push over APNs, a model fleet behind a gate — and every tick landing in the canonical record within a minute.

SPEC 01 · REQUIREMENTS WITH PROVENANCE

Not a dashboard. A gate.

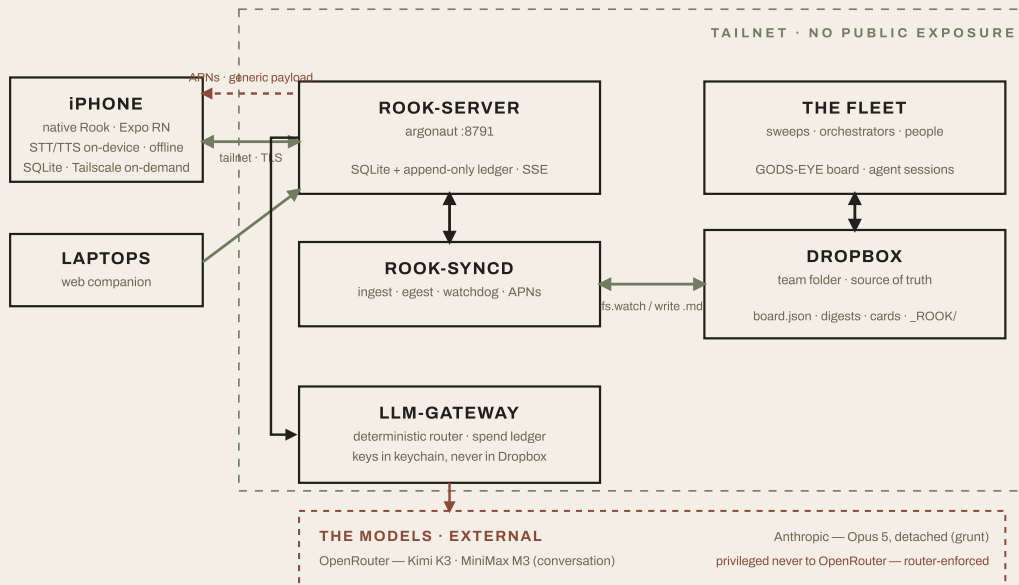
Twenty requirements, each motivated by a named incident on the record – P13 onward new in v2; anything that serves none of these gets cut.

INCIDENT ON THE RECORD	REQUIREMENT IT CREATES
P1 · BOARD.md at 688KB — re-ballooned a fortnight after being split	Items live in a database. Markdown becomes a generated view, never the store.
P2 · Audit R013: "no stable decision object"	A typed, versioned Item with append-only history is the core entity.
P3 · "No genuine FM decision recorded since 13 Aug" — state-lag: decided, recorded late or never	Decisions captured on the phone at the moment of decision, signed by identity — not reconstructed by a sweep.
P4 · Terra C9: "an alert is not an action"	Deadline items require a decision transition; undecided criticals push-escalate at T-48h, T-24h, T-3h.
P5 · "A completed document waiting on a release decision"	A Dispatch screen: staged items age visibly, nag daily, release in one tap.
P6 · "Whether it was actually sent is NOT recorded" · "machine sends nothing; FM sends"	Release is a first-class event: actor, timestamp, token, proof pointer. Rook stages; a human releases.
P7 · The 34-hour launchd outage; silence looked like health	Freshness banner everywhere; independent cross-alarming watchdogs; staleness pushes once.
P8 · "Velocity is visible. Closure is not."	Metrics on the audited interval: raised → decided → released → verified.
P9 · "Phone calls are invisible" · ten of thirteen meeting actions lost	Ten-second voice capture; a meeting link spawns staged items from the transcript.
P10 · Privileged matters + "no cloud host holds the corpus"	Tailnet-only data plane; role scoping at the query layer; privileged FM-only by default.
P11 · The audit's five-field proof pilot	Every state change stores timestamp / actor / transition / proof / verifier.
P12 · One failed payment instrument nearly took Workspace and Anthropic at once	Runs with Google down; file transport for machines; channel redundancy for pushes.
P13 · FM already rules by option paper and checkbox — B005's five-option paper; 13 Aug went out as "FM checkbox, executed"	Option Cards: categorised tabular checkbox choices — a consequence column, free text always; agents author them as files, the app renders natively.
P14 · 8 Sep: court at 2:15pm, a 16:10 flight — decisions happen in cars and lifts	Native app + push + voice: hands-free review and ruling; notifications without the app open; offline queue everywhere.
P15 · A routing doctrine already exists and works: Kimi as "the eyes", gated; Opus drafts, detached	Rook reuses the fleet doctrine: an OpenRouter frontier model converses; Opus 5 grunts; privileged never leaves the Anthropic/local boundary.
P16 · Panels name documents the reader then has to hunt for — paths quoted in prose, nothing to tap	Click-through everywhere: every folder, file, thread or calendar entry named is a live link — one tap opens it; unresolvable paths render flagged, never silent.
P17 · FM: "the board needs to provide clear context of the matter or issue" — items surface as bare titles	Every item opens with a brief: two to four plain sentences — the matter, what changed, what is asked, by when. No item renders as a title alone; a stale brief is marked stale.
P18 · Severity is a word in a column; nothing tells the thumb what to touch first	A traffic light on every item, derived by rules — never agent vibes. RED pushes; AMBER waits for 07:00; GREEN never pushes. Recolouring is logged.
P19 · FM: "a failure of the board to pick up key items" — ten of thirteen meeting actions lost; lanes ahead of the board	Coverage as machinery: a reconciler raises candidates for anything a lane records that the board lacks; a nightly net stages the decision-shaped; Pulse counts Caught-late.
P20 · FM: "stop drafting emails I will never send" — AI slop without context; a superseded draft sat live in the Gmail folder	Draft discipline: agents never touch the Gmail drafts folder; outbound exists only as a staged dispatch with provenance, drafted at release time; orphans flagged for deletion.

SPEC 02 · THE PLATFORM CALL

Native, and one app.

v2's biggest change: Rook ships as a native iPhone app with direct push, not a PWA — and it is declared the one surface. Nothing else gets built as a separate app for FM once Rook is live.



— The platform call

Expo (React Native), custom dev client, TypeScript end-to-end. Weighed honestly against pure SwiftUI: shared zod schemas and API types with the server — one brain, two runtimes; Cursor productivity is highest in TS; EAS builds ship through **TestFlight internal distribution** (FM + 3, bundle id capital.citadel.rook, no App Store review friction); native modules where it matters — speech, push, keychain. SwiftUI remains a licensed future rewrite of the *shell*: the server contract is UI-agnostic, so nothing is lost by starting in Expo.

Push is direct APNs from argonaut (node-apn, token-based .p8) — no Expo gateway, no Firebase, no third-party transit. Payloads are generic — "2 criticals await", never matter names — and the tap opens the app, which pulls detail over the tailnet. Channels: T-48/24/3 escalations, staged-item nags, freshness alarms, ack/verify events, the 07:00 queue summary. Telegram mirrors as redundancy.

— One app to rule them all

v2 ships the board, dispatch, capture and voice. The same app then absorbs, as read surfaces: the daily briefing and digests (v2.1), matter context packs and the 8787 mailbox excerpts (v2.1), agenda PDFs and Reference-Library lookup (v2.2). The rule: Rook *renders* other systems; it never re-implements them — and nothing else gets built as a separate surface for FM once Rook is live.

Unchanged from v1: Dropbox canonical, SQLite operating; a 30-day parallel run before authority inverts; Tailscale identity with the six-row device map; events append-only with the five proof fields; the `_ROOK/` file contract for agents — now plus cards/.

EXPLICIT NON-GOALS, V2

Not a document editor; not a CRM; no public exposure; no autonomous sending; no privileged documents stored on-device — references and excerpts only, purged on lock; no Android yet; CarPlay deferred — the Siri Shortcut "Ask Rook" covers the car.

SPEC 03 · DECISION OPTION CARDS

Tick the box.

The universal ruling pattern. FM already governs by option paper and checkbox – B005 was a five-option paper; the 13 Aug burn-priorities went out as "FM checkbox, executed". Rook makes that pattern native, categorised and tabular.

Structure

An **Option Card** belongs to an item and contains **categories** – named groups such as *Funding · Legal · Timing* – each holding option rows rendered as a table: checkbox, label, consequence or cost, and a note icon. Card-level config: select: single | multi | per-category, requires_text, allow_custom. A **free-text field is always present** – "or in your own words" – and a per-row note lets any tick be qualified: "yes, but capped at...".

Submitting is a decided event whose proof captures the exact ticks and text verbatim, and the ruling lands in _ROOK/decisions/ as structured YAML *and* prose – sweeps and agent sessions ingest it with no new code.

Three authors

Machine agents write _ROOK/cards/ROK-xxx.card.md – YAML frontmatter defines categories and rows, the body gives context; exactly the B005 five-option-paper pattern, now machine-renderable. **The assistant** drafts a card from an item's context on request – "give me options on Connal" – marked *assistant-drafted*, sources shown. **Humans** compose quick cards in-app. The 07:00 push summarises: "6 cards await ticks."

AN OPTION CARD, AS RENDERED

OPTION	CONSEQUENCE
Funding	single select
☒ Draw on the facility now	certain, costs the margin
☐ Hold for the settlement	free, risks the date
Timing	single select
☐ Release this week	pressure on counsel
☒ Release after the hearing	note: "only if CI green" 
In your own words	always present
"Proceed, but cap the draw at 400 captured verbatim and copy Zach."	

The Queue itself is tabular and categorised – matter → lane → severity – with bulk checkbox mode: select many, act once. The month-old "done, drop next sweep" rows die in one gesture.

SEAMLESSNESS BAR — ACCEPTANCE, NOT ASPIRATION

Push → card rendered under 2 seconds on tailnet · tick + submit in ≤ 3 taps · offline ticks replay losslessly · every tick visible in the Dropbox ledger within 60 seconds of reconnect.

SPEC 04 · ASK ROOK

Say the word.

A voice you can talk to hands-free, plumbed into the model fleet the group already runs — an efficient OpenRouter-sourced frontier model for conversation, Opus 5 for the grunt work, and a deterministic router between them.

— The voice pipeline

Push-to-talk on every screen, a hands-free session mode, and a Siri Shortcut. **On-device STT** → text over the tailnet to the gateway → streamed reply → **on-device TTS**, sentence-chunked with barge-in. **Audio never leaves the phone**; only text transits, and only to the tier the matter allows.

Voice can read the queue — "what's critical today?" — open and summarise an item, take an amendment note, draft a dispatch or an option card (staged), and defer or tick with spoken confirmation. Voice **cannot** release dispatches or close criticals — those stay on-glass taps.

— The assistant's hands

Function-calling against the Rook API, allow-listed: `query_items · get_item · add_amendment · stage_dispatch · draft_card · defer_item · tick_option(confirm)`. Every call is logged as an event with actor: assistant(model); anything beyond the list is refused by the server, not the prompt. The assistant may stage. It may never release, send, or widen its own tool list.

THE GATEWAY — TWO TIERS AND A ROUTER

Conversation **Kimi K3 via OpenRouter** — the efficient frontier model the fleet already trusts as "the eyes", confidentiality gates in standing doctrine; fallback **MiniMax M3** (1M context) for very long Q&A. Voice chat, queue Q&A, item summaries, transcript triage. **Non-privileged matters only**; answers cite item ids; load-bearing claims are marked for verification.

Grunt **Opus 5** (Anthropic API), detached jobs — dispatch bodies and option cards drafted from raw context, nightly board synthesis, meeting links → staged items, long adjudications. Full context allowed including privileged; privileged outputs render only to cleared roles.

Router **Deterministic rules, not a model: privileged** → **Opus only · voice/chat** → **Kimi · >200k context** → **MiniMax · draft/author** → **Opus**. Every call priced into `_ROOK/ledger/llm.jsonl` — the AI spend ledger the audit said doesn't exist, started here.

THE HARD BOUNDARY

Privileged matters go to OpenRouter **never** — enforced in the router by matter flag and proven in CI with a canary item on every build.

Gateway keys live server-side in the keychain: never in Dropbox, never on the phone, never in the repo.

Default voice brain ships as Kimi K3; the switch to MiniMax stays server-side. Voice is FM-only in v2; the team follows in v2.1.

SPEC 05 · THE BRIEF, THE LIGHT, THE NET, THE GAG

State it plainly. Colour it honestly.

Four rules answering the board's observed failures: items without context, priority you cannot read at a glance, key items never picked up, and a drift of AI-drafted emails nobody asked for.

— The brief — context on every item

Every item carries a **brief**: two to four sentences in plain language — what the matter is, what has changed, what is being asked, and by when — written by the authoring agent, kept current by sweeps, timestamped. It renders at the top of the item panel, inside every push → card flow, and it is what the voice assistant reads first. A brief whose timestamp trails the item's last event shows **STALE** in amber on its face; an item without one is itself flagged until an agent or the nightly job writes it. **No item renders as a bare title, anywhere.**

— The traffic light

RED A decision or release is required and dated: due ≤ 72h · staged > 48h · escalated critical · blown gate. **RED pushes.**

AMBER Needs a human this week: aging without movement · ack overdue · conflicting record · stale brief. Appears in the 07:00 summary.

GREEN On track or informational. **Never pushes.**

The colour is **derived by rules the repo can test — never assigned by an agent's mood** — and it drives sort order, batching and push policy on every screen. Recolouring is an event like any other: logged, with the rule that fired.

— Nothing missed — the net

The board's failure to pick up key items is on the record — ten of thirteen meeting actions lost, lanes five documents ahead of the board with no rows raised. So coverage becomes machinery: the **reconciler** diffs the board against lane changelogs on every ingest and raises a **candidate item** for anything a lane records that the board lacks; the **nightly net** — a grunt-tier job — reads the day's digests, meeting links and mailbox excerpts against the queue and stages anything decision-shaped it cannot match; every source has a freshness clock, and a source gone quiet is itself an AMBER item. Pulse counts **Caught-late** — items whose raised date trails their first appearance in the record. Candidates cost one tick to dismiss, and dismissals are logged so the net learns.

— Draft discipline — the gag

The speculative-draft habit ends at the protocol layer: **agents never write to the Gmail drafts folder.** An outbound message exists in exactly one place before sending — a Rook staged dispatch carrying its provenance: the item it serves, the ruling or explicit request that motivated it, its author. The gmail_sa draft is created at **release time, on the human tap**, never before. A staged draft that ages nags once daily, then auto-supersedes after seven days instead of accumulating. And rook-syncd sweeps the drafts folder for **orphans** it did not create, flagging each for one-tap deletion from the phone — the live-hazard class of stale draft becomes a queue item instead of a landmine.

RULE OF THE HOUSE

No draft without a ruling behind it. No item without a brief above it. No colour without a rule beneath it.

SPEC 06 · DATA MODEL & TWO-WAY SYNC

The decision object, at last.

Thirteen tables. One rule: events are append-only – supersede, never overwrite.

THE STORE (SQLITE · DRIZZLE · ZOD-MIRRORED)	
items	id, legacy id preserved, kind, matter, lane, title, brief (+ timestamp), body, light (derived, + reason), status, owner, due, raised, source ref, privileged flag
context_refs	per-item links — Dropbox paths, Gmail threads, calendar events, pinned quotes — every one a tappable deep link, auto-resolved by the importer (P16)
amendments	notes, corrections, questions — authored, timestamped, dictation-friendly
dispatches	to agent or person · body · channel · staged → released → acknowledged → done → verified · release token · proof ref
events	timestamp · actor · transition · proof · verifier — the audit's five fields, on every state change
option_cards · groups · rows	card (select mode, requires_text, authored_by, state) → categories → rows: label, consequence, selected, note, custom flag
card_responses	actor, timestamp, selections as structured data, free text verbatim, event ref
assistant_log	tier, model, tool calls, tokens in/out, cost NZD, item refs — feeds the spend ledger
candidates · orphan_drafts	the net's raised-but-unpromoted items (source, summary, dismiss reason) · Gmail drafts rook-syncd did not create, flagged for deletion
devices · health	person, APNs token, push prefs, last-seen · freshness per source: sweep, syncd, telemetry

Item statuses: open → decided → staged → dispatched → acknowledged → done → verified → closed. Nothing is deleted; supersession is a status, and prior text lives in the ledger.

INBOUND · MACHINES → ROOK	
board.json	Upsert items by legacy id – never clobbering fields Rook owns.
cards	Agent-authored option cards render natively; superseded cards close themselves.
digests · agendas	Attach as matter context; feed the Today strip.
acks · run-log tail	Agent acknowledgements flip dispatch state; sweep freshness feeds the banner.
OUTBOUND · ROOK → THE FLEET	
_ROOK/decisions/	One markdown file per ruling – five-field frontmatter, ticks as YAML and prose. Sweeps ingest rulings with no new code.
_ROOK/dispatch/	Agents' instruction inboxes; agents ack by writing a file back. One doctrine page makes every session check its inbox at wake.
people	Scoped Rook view + optional gmail_sa draft for one-tap send + Telegram ping. Rook itself never emails anyone.
_ROOK/ledger/	Continuous JSONL mirror of events + the llm spend ledger + nightly DB snapshot – the record survives any machine.

SPEC 07 · ONE THUMB, OR NO HANDS

Six screens, no more.

44-point touch targets, dark mode for the 02:54 decisions, a push-to-talk button on every one of them.

1 · Today — the triage stack.

Freshness banner, then cards RED-first by the traffic light: criticals ≤ 72h, staged-unreleased with age badges, open option cards, new since last visit. **Swipe right = decide; swipe left = defer; long-press = delegate** to a person or agent. Three actions, one thumb.

2 · Queue — the D-series, operable.

Categorised and tabular, coloured by the light: filter by matter, lane, colour, status, owner. **Bulk checkbox mode** — select many, defer / close / supersede once.

3 · Item — everything about one thing.

The brief on top — the matter in plain words · pinned context (quotes, docs, mailbox excerpts via 8787, the calendar entry) · the human-readable event ledger · amendments with voice capture · its option card, rendered · every referenced folder, file and thread a live link — tap to open in Dropbox or the tailnet preview · actions: decide, amend, stage dispatch, **mark verified — which demands a proof reference.**

4 · Dispatch — the heart of it.

Staged: everything awaiting release, grouped by recipient, age badges, a Release button — FM only, token written, channel fired. *In flight:* released items awaiting ack, done, verify; overdue acks flagged. The direct fix for "a completed document waiting on a release decision."

5 · Matters — the fronts at a glance.

One card per front: status line, next hard date, seven-day activity spark, open cards and staged counts, link to the workflow context file.

6 · Pulse — the numbers the next volume quotes.

Decision latency (p50/p90), release latency, queue burn-down, staged-age histogram, verified-versus-claimed, freshness history — and now the AI spend line, straight from the gateway ledger.

Plus global search, quick capture — dictate a thought, file it to a matter, ten seconds — and "Ask Rook" from anywhere, including the lock-screen Siri Shortcut.

SPEC 08 · CURSOR-READY

Twenty-four days, six gates.

Monorepo: apps/mobile (Expo), apps/server, apps/web, packages/shared. Repo FM1983/rook, private. Each phase ends usable, each gate is runnable – "looks good" is not a test.

THE PHASES

0 · Steel d1-2	Monorepo, schema, tailnet serve, identity, health, APNs hello-world. Gate: a generic push arrives with the app closed; the tap opens the app; /api/health over tailnet shows identity.
1 · Mirror d2-6	Importer + ingest; native Today/Queue/Item/Matters read-only; SSE; freshness banner; offline read cache. Gate: a sweep-written red flag on the phone in under 60s; an airplane-mode reopen still shows the queue.
2 · Decide d6-11	Option Cards end-to-end; decide/defer/amend; quick voice capture; offline action queue; bulk checkbox mode. Gate: an agent-authored card is ruled in a lift; the .md ruling appears in Dropbox with the exact ticks; a sweep reflects it next cycle.
3 · Dispatch d11-15	Staging, tokened release, agent inbox/ack loop, draft + Telegram channels, aging nags, T-48/24/3 push escalations. Gate: a test agent acks by file and state flips on the phone; a stale staged item nags exactly once daily.
4 · Voice d15-20	Gateway, two tiers, router, spend ledger; push-to-talk and hands-free; assistant tools; Siri Shortcut. Gate: "what's critical, open the second one, note this, draft the dispatch" – completed without touching glass; the privileged canary provably never reaches OpenRouter; every call priced.
5 · Prove d20-24	Verify flow, Pulse, ledger mirror, cross-alarming watchdogs, role scoping, TestFlight to the team. Gate: the 30-day parallel run starts; a killed daemon is alarmed within ten minutes.

SECURITY — THE V2 ANNEX

Everything from v1 stands: tailnet-only, ts.net TLS, privileged matters excluded **at the query layer**, the immutable ledger, no secrets in the repo. v2 adds: APNs payloads carry zero content beyond counts and generic labels. The on-device cache excludes privileged bodies – references only, Face ID app lock, purge on role change. Gateway keys server-side only; the OpenRouter key arrives from FM directly and never touches Dropbox. Voice transcripts stored only when explicitly saved. The assistant cannot release, send, or widen its own tool list.

DEFINITION OF DONE

FM clears a real week from the phone; ≥ 80% of that week's decisions exist in Rook *before* any sweep infers them; zero staged items silently older than 72 hours; and the next Pulse quotes Rook's numbers – including the first real AI spend figures the estate has ever had.

Design: bone paper, ink, Citadel green as the only accent, rust for criticals; Archivo with tabular numerals; Fraunces for the wordmark alone. Tokens shipped as a file and consumed literally.

ROOK

Build specification v2.1 — the Citadel command app, native on the iPhone. Supersedes v1.0. The operative artifact is SPEC.md in the repository; this document is its typeset twin for review.

Written against the live record: the decision-object and material-decision-gate findings, the five-field proof pilot, the release-discipline failures of August, the launchd outage, the checkbox rulings that already govern, and the fleet's own model-routing doctrine. Open items are four and none block Phase 0: the Apple Developer account for capital.citadel (needed by day one for APNs and TestFlight), Kimi versus MiniMax as the default voice brain, whether the team gets voice in v2 or v2.1, and a SwiftUI shell rewrite considered only after the parallel run passes. Tick the box, say the word, and the record keeps itself.

ISSUE

Spec v2.1

REPO

FM1983 / rook

BUILD IN

Cursor · 6 phases

IMPRINT

Citadel · Lightspeed